

Okta Identity and Access Management Lab

Objective: This lab demonstrates core Identity and Access Management skills using Okta as the central Identity Provider in a simulated corporate IT environment. The goal was to execute a complete employee identity lifecycle from scratch: provision user accounts, organize access through group-based policy scoping, enforce Multi-Factor Authentication, integrate Google Workspace via SAML 2.0 Single Sign-On, perform common helpdesk break-fix procedures, and offboard the user through account deactivation. The lab was completed with no prior Okta experience. All configuration decisions, integration steps, troubleshooting outcomes, and verification evidence are documented below.

Platform	Okta Integrator Free Plan (developer.okta.com)
Admin Interface	Browser-based Okta Admin Console
Okta Engine	Okta Identity Engine (OIE)
Domain	eguzmanit.xyz (live domain, Cloudflare DNS)
Test User	Jane Doe / jdoe@eguzmanit.xyz (IT Department)
SSO Integration	Google Workspace Business Starter (SAML 2.0)
Objective	Simulate a complete IT helpdesk identity lifecycle workflow using Okta as the Identity Provider, from new hire onboarding through account deactivation

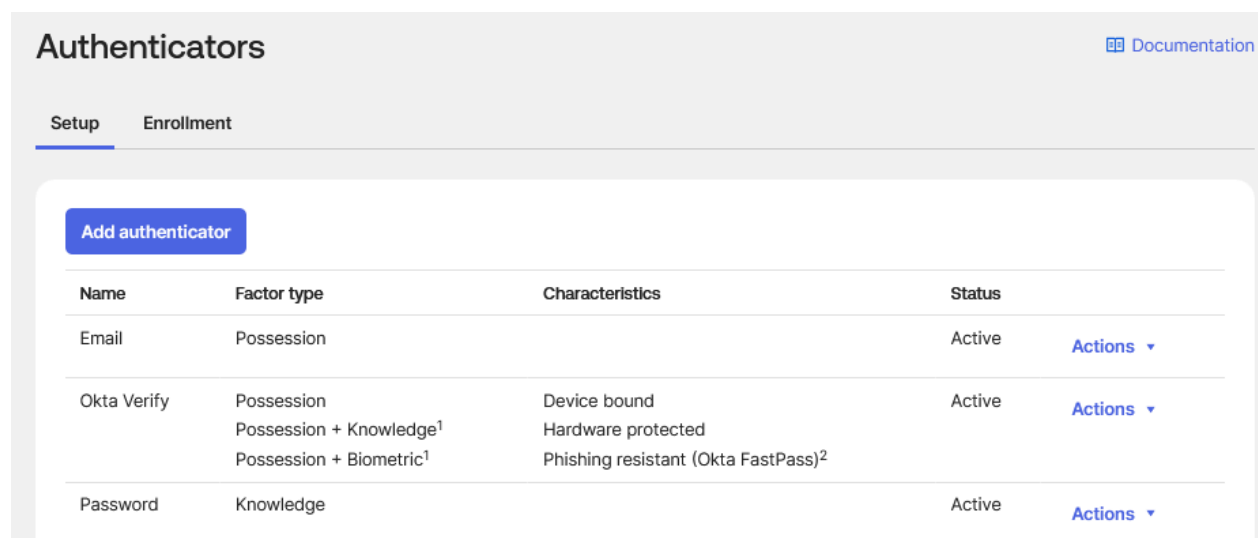
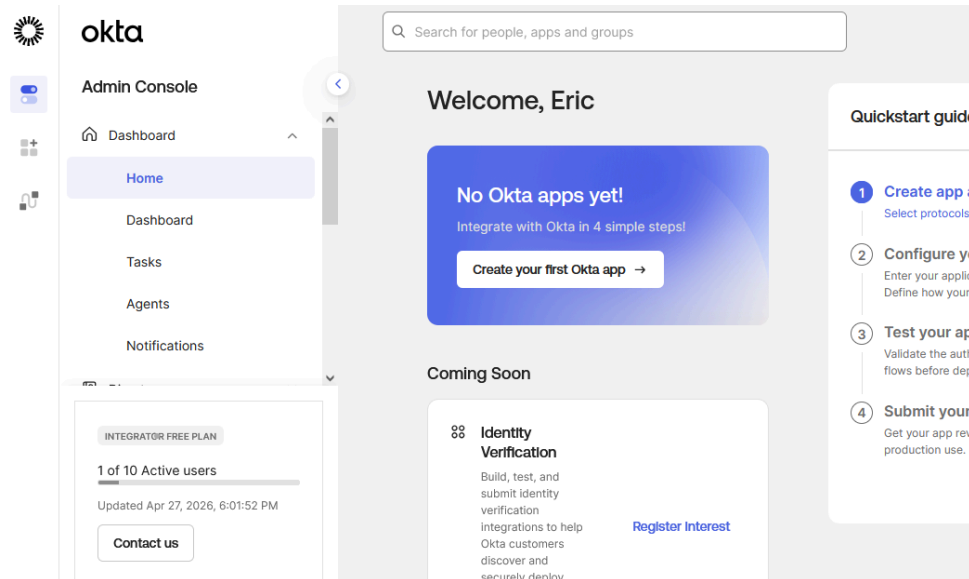
Background: Okta is a cloud-based Identity Provider used by organizations to centralize authentication and access control across all applications and systems. Rather than maintaining separate credentials per tool, Okta serves as the single source of truth for identity. Users authenticate once through Okta and are granted access to every assigned application without logging in again. This is Single Sign-On.

Identity lifecycle management is organized through three core building blocks. Users are individual accounts representing employees. Groups are containers that control which applications and policies apply to which users. Adding a user to a group instantly grants everything the group provides, and removing them revokes it. Applications are connected to Okta via pre-built integrations or manual SAML configuration, and are assigned at the group level.

MFA enforcement in Okta Identity Engine is policy-driven rather than opt-in. Authentication Policies are scoped per application and a Global Session Policy governs the overall Okta session. MFA fires as a condition of access, not a user setting. The System Log is Okta's built-in audit trail, logging every action with actor, target, timestamp, and IP address. It is the primary tool for troubleshooting and security investigations.

Phase 1: Tenant Setup and Admin Console Orientation

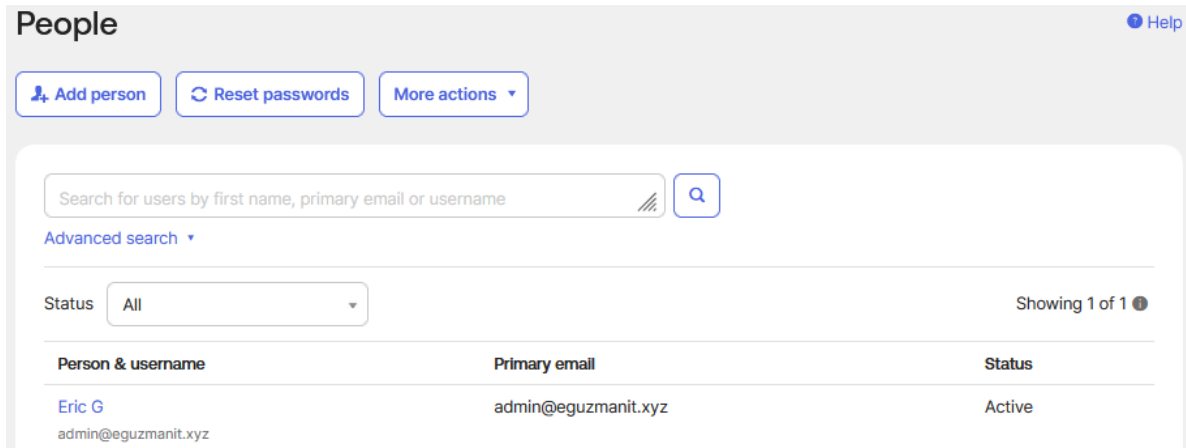
The tenant was provisioned on Okta Identity Engine. OIE differs from the legacy Classic Engine in how it handles MFA: rather than org-wide Sign-On Policies, OIE uses Authentication Policies scoped per application, giving administrators more granular control over security requirements.



The Admin Console home view confirms the four primary navigation sections: Directory for user and group management, Applications for SSO integrations, Security for policy and authenticator configuration, and Reports for the System Log. The Integrator Free Plan badge and active user count confirm the environment. The Authenticators page shows three active authenticators: Email (possession), Okta Verify (possession, knowledge, and biometric including phishing-resistant FastPass), and Password (knowledge). Okta Verify supports multiple factor types from a single enrollment, making it the preferred enterprise authenticator and the primary MFA method used in this lab.

Phase 2: User Provisioning

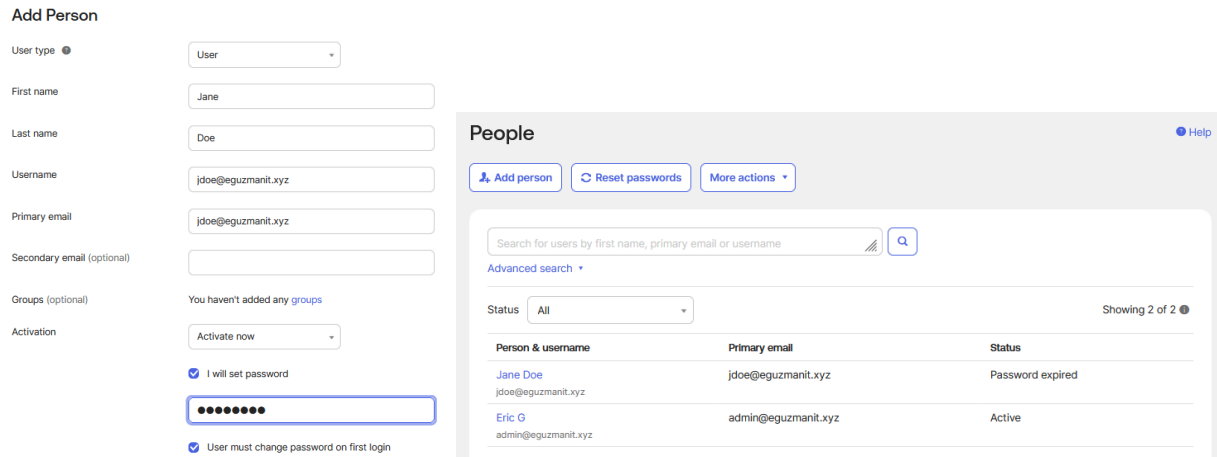
User provisioning is the first action taken when a new employee joins an organization. In environments without HR system automation via SCIM, this is a manual helpdesk task. Okta tracks each account through a defined status lifecycle that reflects the user's current access state.



The screenshot shows the 'People' directory in Okta. At the top, there are buttons for 'Add person', 'Reset passwords', and 'More actions'. Below these is a search bar with the placeholder text 'Search for users by first name, primary email or username'. A dropdown menu for 'Status' is set to 'All'. The table below shows one user: Eric G, with primary email admin@eguzmanit.xyz and status Active.

Person & username	Primary email	Status
Eric G admin@eguzmanit.xyz	admin@eguzmanit.xyz	Active

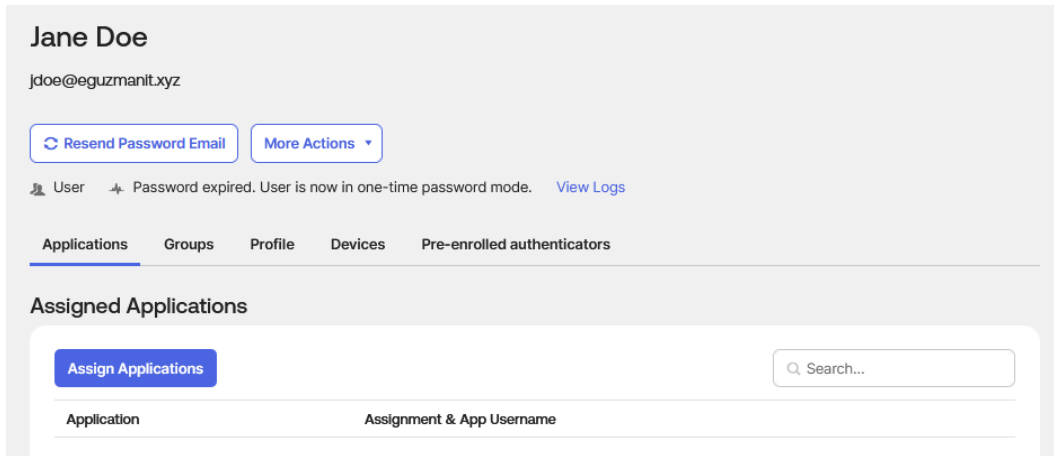
The clean People directory shows only the administrator account, confirming a fresh starting point before any test users were created.



The screenshot shows the 'Add Person' form on the left and the 'People' directory on the right. The form is filled out for Jane Doe with username jdoe@eguzmanit.xyz and primary email jdoe@eguzmanit.xyz. The 'Activation' dropdown is set to 'Activate now'. Two checkboxes are checked: 'I will set password' and 'User must change password on first login'. The password field is filled with dots. The 'People' directory on the right shows two users: Jane Doe with status 'Password expired' and Eric G with status 'Active'.

Person & username	Primary email	Status
Jane Doe jdoe@eguzmanit.xyz	jdoe@eguzmanit.xyz	Password expired
Eric G admin@eguzmanit.xyz	admin@eguzmanit.xyz	Active

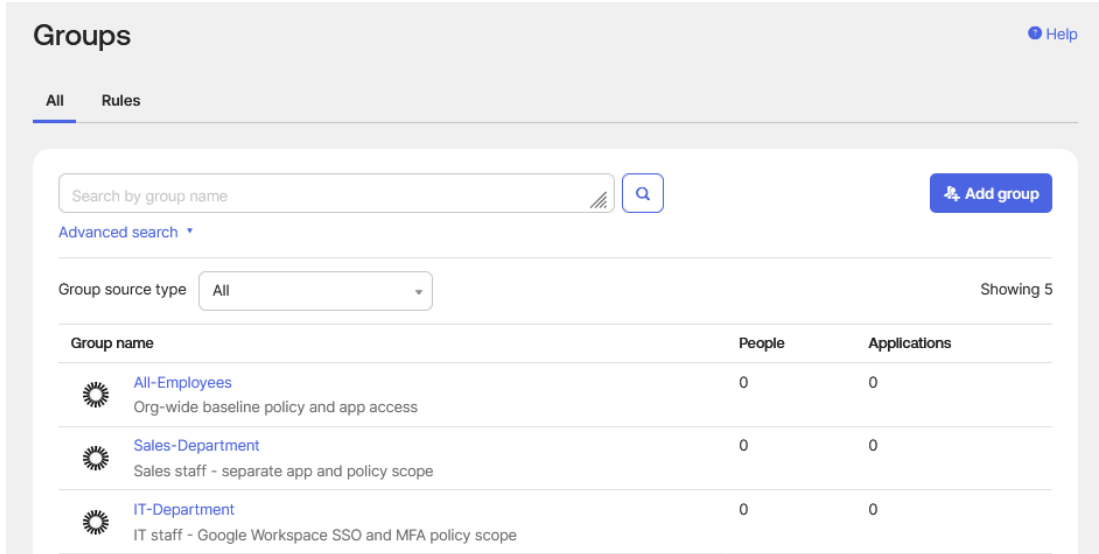
The Add Person form is filled out for Jane Doe with username and primary email set to jdoe@eguzmanit.xyz. The 'User must change password on first login' checkbox is checked, a security baseline requirement that ensures the administrator never knows the employee's working password after initial setup. Activation is set to 'Activate now,' bypassing the staged flow. After creation, Jane Doe appears in the directory with a status of 'Password expired,' which is the expected state when an admin sets a temporary password with the forced change option enabled.



Jane Doe's profile page is the primary view a helpdesk technician uses when working a ticket for a specific user. The tabs visible here, Applications, Groups, Profile, Devices, and Pre-enrolled authenticators, give a complete picture of the user's access state, group memberships, and enrolled MFA methods from a single screen.

Phase 3: Group Management and Access Control

Groups are the primary mechanism for scaling access control in Okta. Rather than assigning applications and policies to individual users, administrators assign them to groups. This means adding a new employee to the correct group instantly grants them every application and policy the group provides, without touching individual application configurations.



Three groups were created to model a realistic department structure. IT-Department scopes Google Workspace SSO access and the MFA policy. Sales-Department demonstrates that app and policy assignments can be isolated by department. All-Employees serves as the org-wide catch-all for baseline policies. The People count showing 0 at this point is expected since users are assigned to groups in the next step. Note that Okta also provides a system-managed 'Everyone' group that cannot be removed. All-Employees was kept as a separate intentional group to avoid scoping security policies to the Everyone group, which includes the admin account and could cause unintended policy application during testing.

Jane Doe

jdoe@eguzmanit.xyz

Resend Password Email

More Actions

User

Password expired. User is now in one-time password mode.

View Logs

Applications

Groups

Profile

Devices

Pre-enrolled authenticators

Groups

Group	
Everyone All users in your organization	×
IT-Department IT staff - Google Workspace SSO and MFA policy scope	×
All-Employees Org-wide baseline policy and app access	×

Jane Doe's Groups tab shows her assigned to IT-Department, All-Employees, and the system Everyone group. The IT-Department assignment is what grants her Google Workspace access in Phase 5. The All-Employees assignment is what subjects her to the MFA enrollment policy configured in Phase 4.

Phase 4: MFA Policy Configuration

Multi-Factor Authentication enforcement in Okta Identity Engine is handled through two separate policy layers: the Global Session Policy, which governs the overall Okta session and MFA enrollment requirements, and Authentication Policies, which are scoped per application and define what factors are required to access that specific app.

App sign-in policies

Create policy

Define how a user must authenticate to gain access to an app.

Q Search

⋮ Ⓞ

NAME	DESCRIPTION	APPLIES TO		
Any two factors				
Default	Require two factors to access.	3 apps	✎	⋮
Okta Admin Console				
Application-specific policy	--	1 app	✎	⋮
Okta Browser Plugin				
--	--	1 app	✎	⋮
Okta Dashboard				
--	--	1 app	✎	⋮
Okta OIN Submission Tester				
--	--	1 app	✎	⋮

The App sign-in policies list shows five default system-managed policies before any custom configuration. These were left untouched. A custom policy named Standard Employee MFA Policy was created to scope MFA requirements to test users without affecting admin access.

Add Rule

If all of the conditions are true, the authentication settings below will apply. Otherwise, Okta will evaluate the next rule.

Rule name

Require MFA - All Employees

IF

IF

User's user type is

Any user type

AND

User's group membership includes

At least one of the following groups:

⚙ All-Employees x

And none of the following groups:

Enter groups to exclude...

Go to Groups

AND

User is

Any user

AND

Device state is

Any

Registered

Setup Okta Verify as Authenticator

The rule named 'Require MFA - All Employees' uses an IF condition scoped to the All-Employees group, meaning any user in that group hitting a protected application will be subject to this rule. The rule conditions use Okta's expression-based logic, allowing precise targeting without affecting users outside the scope.

AND Device platform is Any platform ▾

Device platform is securely verified for registered devices. For unregistered devices, it's determined by the user-agent and can be modified. Learn more about [Device platform security](#) 

AND User's IP is Any IP ▾

AND Risk is Any ▾

AND The following custom expression is true

This is an optional advanced setting. If the expression is formatted incorrectly or conflicts with conditions set above, the rule may not match any users.

[Expression language reference](#) 

THEN

THEN Access is ☐ Denied
☒ Allowed after successful authentication

AND User must authenticate with Any 2 factor types ▾

AND Possession factor constraints are ☒ Phishing resistant
☐ Hardware protected
☒ Require user interaction
☒ Any interaction

The THEN section sets access to allowed after successful authentication, requiring any 2 factor types with possession factor constraints set to phishing-resistant and requiring user interaction. Given the phishing-resistant possession constraint, Okta Verify FastPass is the only authenticator in this org that satisfies the requirement. Email and Password cannot meet the phishing-resistant possession constraint. The completed rule is shown in its enabled state with the full authenticator summary visible confirming which combinations satisfy the requirement.

Add Rule

Rule name

MFA Enrollment - All Employees

Exclude users

Exclude users

Policy settings

IF

User's IP is

Anywhere

Manage configuration for [Networks](#)

AND

Identity provider is

Any

AND

Authenticates via

Any

AND

Behavior is

Select behavior

AND

Risk is

Any

THEN

Access is

Allowed

Establish the user session with

☒ Any factor used to meet the Authentication Policy requirements ⓘ

☐ A password ⓘ

An IdP claim will satisfy either of these options. The [Authentication Policy](#) determines the authentication requirement for a request.

Multifactor authentication (MFA) is

☐ Not required

☒ Required

You can use the [Authentication Policy](#) to define multifactor requirements and characteristics of the allowed [authenticators](#).

Users will be prompted for MFA

☒ At every sign in

☐ When signing in with a new device cookie

☐ After MFA lifetime expires for the device cookie

[Learn more about how MFA is prompted in documentation](#)

1

Require MFA - All Employees

ENABLED

Actions

IF

Group: All-Employees

THEN

Access: Allowed with any 2 factor types

Your org's authenticators that satisfy this requirement:

Knowledge / Biometric factor types

Password or Okta Verify - FastPass¹

AND

Additional factor types

Okta Verify - FastPass¹

¹ Authenticator that may satisfy multiple factor requirements

³ Phishing resistance may vary based on combinations of apps, browser, operating system, and more. [Learn more](#).

Your org allows users to verify their identity with a knowledge factor (Password) before the possession factor. To change this, protect against password-based attacks in [Security > General](#)

Possession factor constraints: Phishing resistant, Require user interaction

Authentication methods: Allow any method that can be used to meet the requirement

Re-authentication frequency is: Every 1 hours

A rule named 'MFA Enrollment - All Employees' was added to the Global Session Policy Default Policy. Multifactor authentication is set to Required and users will be prompted at every sign in. Any user in scope who has not enrolled an authenticator will be forced to do so before completing their first login, and MFA will be re-challenged on each new session. This is the policy-enforced MFA model that distinguishes a secure environment from one that relies on users opting in voluntarily.

Global Session Policy

[Documentation](#)

Use this policy to set the user session length so that users can switch between apps with ease. You may also apply blocking rules to your entire org, or require an org-wide Password or 2FA. For flexibility and control, use [Authentication Policies](#) to define authentication requirements for specific applications.

Add policy

1 Default Policy

Default Policy

Description

The default policy applies in all situations if no other policy applies.

Assigned to groups

Everyone

Add rule

Priority	Rule name	Access	Status	Actions
1	MFA Enrollment - All Employees	Allowed	Active	
2	Default Rule	Allowed	Active	

The completed Global Session Policy shows the MFA Enrollment rule at priority 1 above the Default Rule, confirming correct rule ordering. Rules are evaluated top-down, so the MFA enrollment requirement fires before the catch-all default.

Phase 5: Google Workspace SSO Integration via SAML 2.0

SAML 2.0 is the protocol that enables Single Sign-On between an Identity Provider and a Service Provider. In this integration, Okta is the IdP and Google Workspace is the SP. When a user attempts to access Google Workspace, Google redirects them to Okta for authentication. Okta verifies the user's identity, generates a signed XML assertion, and sends it back to Google. Google trusts this assertion because it was signed with Okta's certificate, which Google has on file from the initial configuration. The user gains access without ever entering a Google password. This section required provisioning a Google Workspace Business Starter subscription on the eguzmanit.xyz domain, which is a real domain managed through Cloudflare DNS. Domain verification was completed via TXT record.

**Single sign-on (SSO) with third-party identity providers (IDPs)**

Set up SSO so users can sign in with a third-party IDP to access Google Workspace services.
[Learn more](#)

Third-party SSO profiles

Below are SSO profiles you can assign to org units or groups. [Learn about SSO profiles](#)

[ADD OIDC PROFILE](#) [ADD SAML PROFILE](#)

Name	Type	Status
Microsoft	OIDC	System profile 

Manage SSO profile assignments



Manage SSO profile assignments for organizational units or groups

The Google Admin Console SSO configuration page before any profiles were created. Only the system Microsoft OIDC profile exists. This is the clean state before the Okta SAML profile was added.

[← Back to Applications](#)

**Google Workspace**
[Active](#)      [View Logs](#) [Monitor Imports](#)

[General](#) [Sign On](#) [Provisioning](#) [Import](#) [Assignments](#) [Push Groups](#)

App Settings

[Edit](#)

Application label	Google Workspace
Your Google Apps company domain	eguzmanit.xyz
Display the following links	☒  Mail ☒  Drive ☒  Calendar ☒  Sites ☒  Account ☒  Keep
Seats (optional)	0

General Settings

All fields are required unless marked optional. Some fields may no longer be editable.

Google Workspace was added to Okta through the Okta Integration Network, a catalog of pre-built application integrations. The OIN integration handles certificate exchange and attribute mapping automatically, significantly reducing configuration complexity versus a manual SAML setup. The General tab confirms the application label and the Google Apps company domain set to eguzmanit.xyz.

SSO profile values

Copy the following values as required when you configure an SSO profile in Google Workspace.

- IDP entity ID:

google.com/a/eguzmanit.xyz

- Sign-in page URL:

https://integrator-██████.okta.com/app/google-██████.sso/saml

- Sign-out page URL:

https://integrator-██████.okta.com

- Verification certificate: Download and save the following file, then locate and upload it.

<https://integrator-██████.admin.okta.com/admin/org/security/██████.cert>

- Change password URL:

https://integrator-██████.okta.com/enduser/settings

The SAML setup instructions page in Okta provides the values entered on the Google side: IDP Entity ID, Sign-in page URL, Sign-out page URL, verification certificate, and Change password URL. All are generated by Okta and specific to this integration instance. Tenant-specific identifiers have been redacted. The verification certificate was downloaded in SHA-2 format.

Add a new SAML SSO profile

SAML SSO profile

SSO profile name
Okta SAML SSO

13/140

Service provider (SP) details

To see the SP entity ID and ACS URL, save this SSO profile first. You can always add IDP details after saving.

Autofill email

If your IDP supports login hints to autofill a user's email address (username) on their sign-in prompt, select the parameter format they accept. [Learn more about login hints and IDP support](#)

- ☐ Don't use login hints
- ☐ Send email address in the URL as the *login_hint* parameter
For example, Microsoft Entra supports this format
- ☒ Send email address in the URL as the *LoginHint* parameter
For example, Okta supports this format

IDP details

IDP entity ID
google.com/a/eguzmanit.xyz

The Google SAML profile was configured with profile name 'Okta SAML SSO,' Autofill email set to the LoginHint parameter format that Okta supports, and the IDP Entity ID from Okta's setup instructions. The LoginHint parameter allows Google to pre-populate the username field on the Okta login page during the SSO redirect.

Advanced Sign-on Settings

These fields may be required for a Google Workspace proprietary sign-on option or general setting.

RPID

eguzmanit.xyz

Please enter your RPID

User authentication

Cancel

Authentication policy

Standard Employee MFA Policy

Save

Cancel

On the Okta side, the RPID field was set to eguzmanit.xyz in Advanced Sign-on Settings. This field is specific to the Google Workspace OIN integration and identifies which Google domain Okta is serving. The Standard Employee MFA Policy was applied to this application, meaning users will be required to satisfy MFA every time they access Google Workspace through Okta.

The screenshot shows the Google Workspace application configuration in Okta. The top section includes the Google Workspace logo, an 'Active' status dropdown, and several icons for user management. Below this is a navigation bar with tabs: General, Sign On, Provisioning, Import, Assignments (selected), and Push Groups. The main content area is titled 'Assignments' and features a table with columns for 'Priority' and 'Assignment'. A sidebar on the left shows 'Filters' with 'People' and 'Groups' options. The table lists one assignment: 'IT-Department' with a priority of 1, assigned to 'IT staff - Google Workspace SSO and MFA policy scope'. There are edit and delete icons for this assignment.

Priority	Assignment
1	IT-Department IT staff - Google Workspace SSO and MFA policy scope

IT-Department was assigned to the Google Workspace app in Okta. This group-based assignment means any current or future member of IT-Department receives access automatically without helpdesk needing to touch the application configuration.

Manage SSO profile assignments

SSO profile assignment
Applied at 'EG IT'

This policy only applies to your organizations' users. To manage settings for guests, select the 'Workspace Guests' organizational unit. [Learn more about Guests](#)

Choose how users in this organizational unit or group sign in. [Learn about SSO profiles](#)

Select SSO profile

Okta SAML SSO - SAML

Select what happens if users go directly to a Google service without first signing in with this SSO profile's third-party IDP. The SSO profile's **Change password URL** only applies if you select the first option. Otherwise, users who need to change passwords use Google. [Learn more](#)

☒ Have Google prompt for their username, then redirect them to this profile's IDP sign-in page

☐ Require users to enter their Google username and password to sign in

Most changes take effect in a few minutes. [Learn more](#)
You can view prior changes in the [Audit log](#)

2 unsaved changes

CANCEL

SAVE

The Google Admin Console SSO profile assignment for the EG IT organizational unit was set to 'Have Google prompt for their username, then redirect them to this profile's IDP sign-in page.' This completes the SSO redirect chain: when a user in the EG IT OU navigates to any Google service, Google prompts for their email, recognizes the domain, and redirects authentication to Okta automatically.

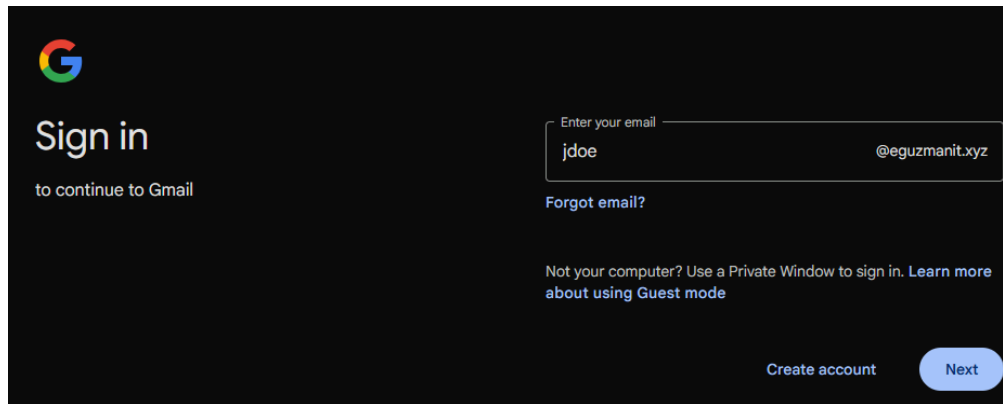
Phase 6: SSO Flow Verification and Troubleshooting

The SSO flow was tested using an incognito browser window to simulate a fresh user session. Jane Doe was first provisioned in the Google Admin Console at `jdoe@eguzmanit.xyz` and placed in the EG IT organizational unit. A matching user account in Google Workspace is required for Okta's SAML assertion to resolve to a valid identity on the Google side.

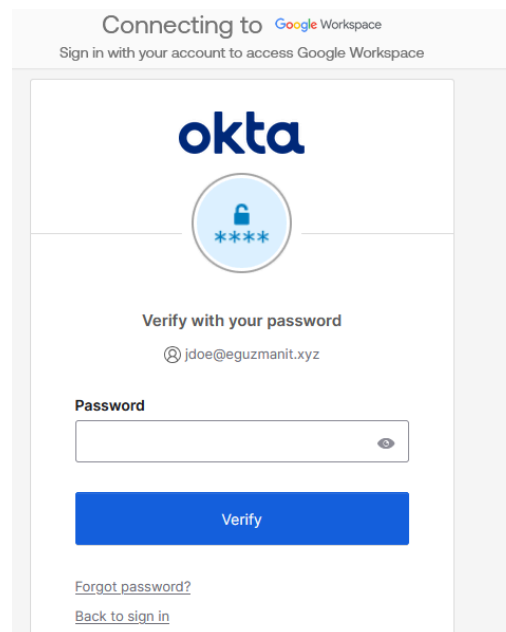
First name*	Last name*	Primary email address*	Secondary email address
Secondary emails are used to send sign in instructions			
Jane	Doe	jdoe	@eguzmanit.xyz
			@eguzmanit.xyz
			@eguzmanit.xyz

+ Add another user

Jane Doe provisioned in the Google Admin Console user creation form at `jdoe@eguzmanit.xyz`, confirming the matching account exists on the Google side before SSO testing begins.



Navigating to `mail.google.com/a/eguzmanit.xyz` in an incognito window triggers the domain-specific login flow. Google recognizes that the `eguzmanit.xyz` domain has SSO configured and presents the login prompt with the domain pre-filled. This confirms the SSO redirect is functioning at the Google entry point.



After entering the username, Google redirects the browser to Okta for authentication. The Okta login page displays 'Connecting to Google Workspace' and 'Sign in with your account to access Google Workspace,' confirming the SAML redirect is working correctly and Okta has received the authentication request from Google. The user's email `jdoe@eguzmanit.xyz` is pre-populated via the `LoginHint` parameter configured earlier.

During initial testing, authentication was succeeding on the Okta side but Google was returning a 'contact your domain admin' error. Investigation via the Okta System Log confirmed that Okta was generating and sending the SAML assertion successfully, with the event recorded as 'User single sign on to app: SUCCESS.' The error was isolated to the Google side. The root cause was that Jane Doe's Google Workspace account had never been initialized through a direct login, which prevented Google from completing the SSO handshake. The resolution was to temporarily revert the EG IT SSO profile assignment to 'Users sign in with Google,' allow Jane to complete a direct Google login to initialize her account, then re-enable the Okta SSO profile.



Set up security methods

@ jdoe@eguzmanit.xyz

Security methods help protect your eguzmanit-
[REDACTED] account by ensuring only
you have access.

Required now



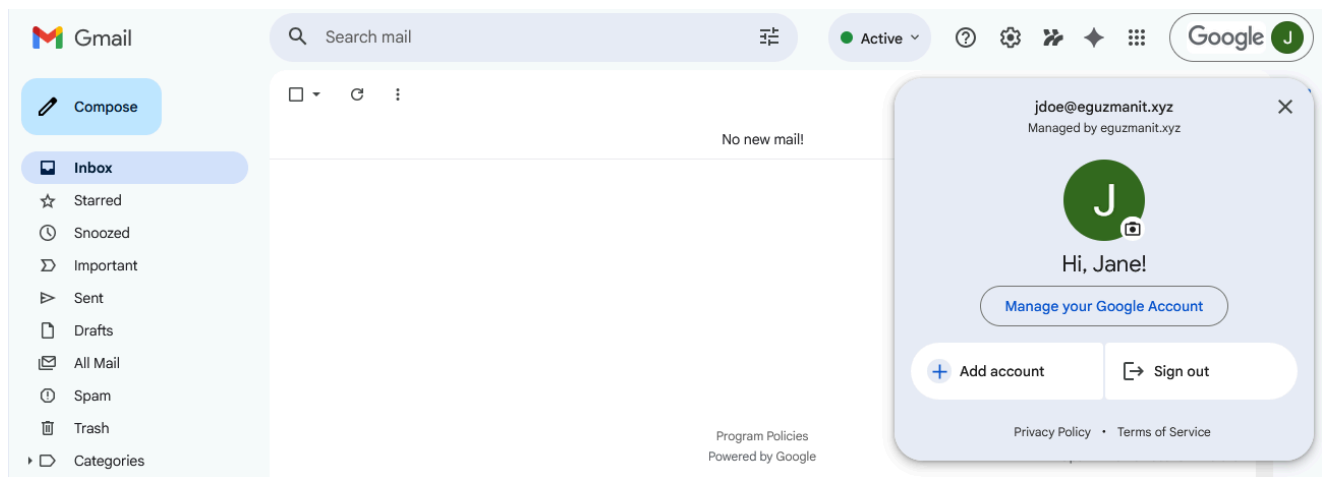
Okta Verify

Okta Verify is an authenticator app,
installed on your phone or computer,
used to prove your identity

[Set up](#)

[Back to sign in](#)

During the SSO flow, the MFA enrollment policy triggered and required Jane Doe to enroll Okta Verify before completing authentication. This confirms the Global Session Policy and Authentication Policy are both functioning as configured. The enrollment prompt appeared inline within the SSO redirect flow, meaning the user completed MFA setup as part of their first login without requiring a separate enrollment step.



After resolving the initialization issue, the SSO flow completed end-to-end. Jane Doe's Gmail inbox is accessible with the account popup confirming jdoe@eguzmanit.xyz and 'Managed by eguzmanit.xyz,' verifying this is a Google Workspace managed account accessed through Okta SSO. The user authenticated with Okta, satisfied MFA via Okta Verify, and was granted access to Gmail without entering a Google password.

Phase 7: Break-Fix Procedures

Password resets, MFA resets, and account unlocks are among the most common helpdesk tickets in any Okta environment.

Reset Password for Jane Doe

Reset password

☒ Send a reset password email

The email will be sent to the user's primary and secondary emails. If the user has an Okta-sourced password, it is automatically reset. If the user has an AD or LDAP password, it is not reset until the user clicks this link. The link expires in 1 hour.

Verify the user's identity

Anyone who has the email link will be able to create a new password.

☐ Create a temporary password

You will be able to see the temporary password created. Account will be marked as expired. User is required to change their password the next time they sign in.

Sign out of all sessions

☒ Sign out user

User will be signed out of all devices and browsers. [Learn more.](#)

Reset password

Cancel

The Reset Password dialog accessed via More Actions shows both available reset methods. 'Send a reset password email' is the preferred method as it allows the user to set their own password without the administrator ever seeing it, preserving the principle that admins do not know user passwords. 'Create a temporary password' is used for immediate access scenarios such as phone support. The 'Sign out user' checkbox is checked by default, terminating any existing sessions across all devices and browsers when the password resets.

ApplicationsGroupsProfileDevicesAdmin rolesPre-enrolled authenticators

Security Key

NAME	STATUS
------	--------

Add a pre-enrolled security key

Use your YubiEnterprise Delivery account to send this user a pre-enrolled YubiKey for phishing-resistant authentication.

Learn more

+ Add

Jane Doe's Pre-enrolled authenticators tab after a reset shows an empty state, confirming authenticator enrollment was cleared. The user will be prompted to re-enroll MFA on their next

login. This procedure applies when a user loses access to their enrolled device or the device is lost or stolen. Security best practice requires verifying the requester's identity through an out-of-band channel before performing an MFA reset, as social engineering attacks frequently target helpdesk staff by impersonating employees.

Phase 8: System Log Review

The Okta System Log is the complete audit trail for every event in the tenant. It is the primary investigation tool for helpdesk troubleshooting, security reviews, and compliance auditing. Every event is logged with the actor, target, event type, timestamp, and IP address, creating a non-repudiable record of administrative actions.

③	Apr 29 20:17:17	Eric G (User)	Add user to application membership SUCCESS	Jane Doe (AppUser) Google Workspace (AppInstance) 1 more targets
③	Apr 28 20:02:38	Eric G (User)	Add user to group membership SUCCESS	Jane Doe (User) All-Employees (UserGroup)
③	Apr 28 20:01:04	Eric G (User)	Remove user from group membership SUCCESS	Jane Doe (User) All-Employees (UserGroup)
③	Apr 28 20:00:54	Eric G (User)	Add user to group membership SUCCESS	Jane Doe (User) IT-Department (UserGroup)
③	Apr 28 20:00:49	Eric G (User)	Add user to group membership SUCCESS	Jane Doe (User) All-Employees (UserGroup)
③	Apr 28 18:55:38	Eric G (User)	Activate Okta user SUCCESS	Jane Doe (User)
③	Apr 28 18:55:38	Eric G (User)	User update password for Okta SUCCESS	Jane Doe (User)
③	Apr 28 18:55:38	Eric G (User)	Create okta user SUCCESS	Jane Doe (User)
③	Apr 28 18:55:38	Eric G (User)	Activate factor for user SUCCESS	Jane Doe (User)

The System Log filtered to Jane Doe's email shows her complete identity lifecycle from bottom to top: account creation, password initialization, activation, group membership assignments to All-Employees and IT-Department, a group removal and re-addition during testing, and finally assignment to the Google Workspace application. Every action taken during the lab is captured and auditable, with the administrator as the actor throughout, matching the expected helpdesk pattern.

Phase 9: Employee Offboarding

Offboarding is one of the highest-risk processes in IT operations. Every minute an account remains active after an employee's departure is a potential window for unauthorized access. Okta's centralized model allows a single deactivation action to simultaneously revoke access to every connected application.

Deactivate Person

X

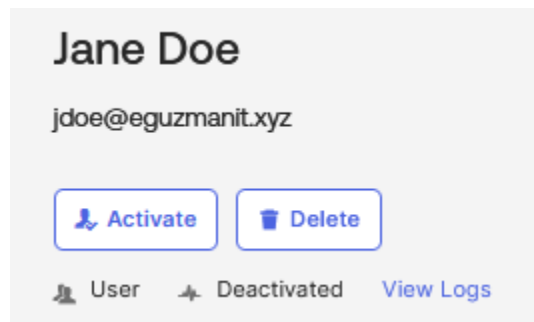
Are you sure you want to deactivate Jane Doe?

Important: Once deactivated, this person cannot sign-in to Okta to access their applications. You can always reactivate this person's account at a later time, but they will have to reset their password.

Deactivate

Cancel

The Deactivate Person dialog confirms the behavior: once deactivated, the user cannot sign in to Okta or access any connected applications. The account is not deleted. Deactivation preserves the account record, group history, and audit log for compliance retention requirements. Deletion is a separate irreversible action taken only after the retention period has passed. Before deactivation, active sessions were cleared via More Actions > Clear User Sessions to prevent existing browser sessions in downstream applications from persisting past the deactivation.



Jane Doe's profile after deactivation shows Activate and Delete as the only available actions, confirming no further access-granting operations are possible on a deactivated account. The status reflects the two valid next steps: reactivation if the employee returns, or permanent deletion after the retention period has passed.

Summary

This lab demonstrated a complete Okta IAM workflow covering every phase of the employee identity lifecycle in a real, functional environment. The Google Workspace SAML integration was completed end-to-end including live SSO verification, MFA enrollment confirmation, and audit log validation. Troubleshooting the SSO flow required using the Okta System Log to isolate the failure point and identify that the issue was on the Google side rather than in the Okta configuration, which reflects a real diagnostic workflow. All configuration was performed on live systems using production-grade tooling with no prior Okta experience, using the Okta Integrator Free Plan and a Google Workspace Business Starter subscription on a real domain.